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Retiring with Kids

Twenty-five years ago half the households in America contained children under age 18. You grew up in one of them. Dad drove a Chevy to work and Mom was a housewife. You lived in Peoria with your 2.2 brothers or sisters. You watched Walter Cronkite on TV, went to Marilyn Monroe movies, ate at the new McDonald's across town, and feared that Khrushchev would bury you. You and everyone in your family could read, write, and speak English.

Now only a third of America's households contain children. Those households bear little resemblance to the one you grew up in. Nearly half of all mothers return to work within one year of their child's birth. Moms labor at the office, factory, or store rather than wait with milk and cookies when Johnny comes home from school. Over half of America's kids live with one parent or the other, but not both. Half-brothers and half-sisters may be scattered across the country or around the world. Instead of Peoria, today's family is more likely to live in fast-lane Los Angeles, Dallas, or Miami. Dad drives a Honda or Volkswagen rather than a Chevy. Mom and Dad, if they speak English at all, seldom read or write it. Many kids never read it or write it for the simple reason that they don't know how.